

Foods to eat after surgery

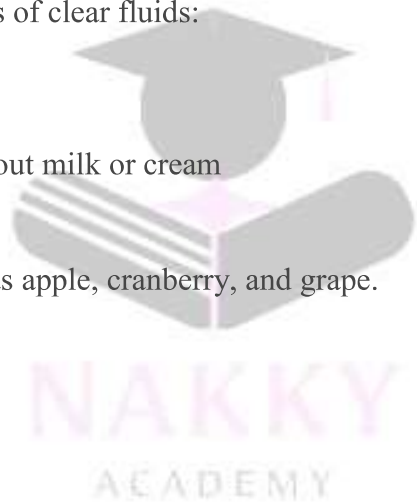
1. Clear and full fluids

Before we talk about good solid food items after surgery, let's first cover clear and full fluids. Clear and full fluids may be the diet of choice if a person undergoes a major operation, particularly one that involves the gastrointestinal tract.

A clear liquid diet provides you the best possible nutrition without compromising your gut. Clear fluid doesn't necessarily mean you'll only have "transparent" liquids; it essentially means the fluid has no (or very little) solid food in it, making digestion easier for your GI tract.

Below are some of the examples of clear fluids:

- Water
- Coffee and tea, but without milk or cream
- Clear soup
- Clear, fresh juice, such as apple, cranberry, and grape.
- Honey and plain sugar
- Jell-O
- Popsicles



Now, a post-surgery diet may also involve a full liquid diet which includes a "fuller" or thicker liquid. Examples of full-liquid you can have are:

- Creamy cereals and soups
- Yogurt
- Plain ice cream
- Fruit and vegetable juices
- Coffee and tea with milk or cream

All items in the clear liquid list can also be consumed under a full fluid diet.

2. Whole grains.

Whole grains are on top of the best foods in a post-surgery diet. Not only are they rich in fiber and energy-giving carbohydrates, but they are also filled with vitamins and nutrients that keep your body healthy and ready for recovery.

There are many ways to add whole grains to the diet. Eating rice is one of them, as well choosing cereals for breakfast. However, please remember to choose whole grains and not the refined variety (white rice, white flour, etc.)

Below are the best examples of whole grain products to include in your post-surgery diet:

- Oatmeal
- Cereals
- Whole-wheat bread, pasta, and crackers
- Brown rice
- Barley



3. Fresh produce

Next on our list of the best foods for post-surgery diet is fresh produce. Fresh fruits and veggies, like whole grains, also have high fiber and nutrients. They are also rich in antioxidants which help fight off free radicals that cause inflammation. If fresh fruits are not available, canned and frozen fruits are also good. However, please be mindful of added contents, particularly sugar.

Still, refrain from consuming too much fruits and vegetables because they might cause gas, which can be quite painful and uncomfortable. And while being gassy typically only lasts a day or two, it may cause abdominal cramping that might require medications.

The best fresh produce to eat after operation include:

- Berries, because you have so many options – from raspberries and strawberries, to blueberries and blackberries. A notable antioxidant content of berries is vitamin C, a micronutrient that helps build collagen for skin repair or wound healing.

- Citrus Fruits which includes oranges, grapefruit, and pomelo are excellent sources of vitamin C, too.
- Other Bright-Colored Fruits such as apples, peaches, mangoes, papaya, peaches, and melon, are also great foods after surgery.
- Leafy greens like spinach, romaine lettuce, and kale are great sources of vitamins A, C, and E. They are also high in vitamin K, which is helpful in blood clotting.
- Vegetables one can snack on such as carrots, cabbage, broccoli, cauliflower.

4. Lean protein sources

Lean protein sources are those that have few fat content. Protein foods are basically foods for wound healing after surgery because they help with tissue repair and infection prevention.

Below are some of the best sources of lean protein:

- Legumes, which include chickpeas, kidney beans, and lentils.
- Poultry, but only choose the white meat parts.
- Seafood
- Beans
- Soy
- Lean beef

5. Healthy fats

It may be a little hard to believe, but a post-surgery diet will not be complete without healthy fats. Fats help in boosting the immune system and preventing infections. Moreover, healthy fats allow you to better absorb the nutrients you get from all the other food groups, particularly from fruits and vegetables.

Some of the best sources of healthy fats include:

- Olive oil, which you can use in cooking or in salad preparation.
- Coconut oil
- Avocado
- Nuts and seeds

6. Anti-inflammatory foods

If you're looking for food for wound healing after surgery, it's a good idea to consider anti-inflammatory foods. These foods basically lower inflammation and might help with swelling and even disease prevention.

Examples of anti-inflammatory foods are:

- Fruits
- Leafy greens
- Nuts
- Olive oil



7. Foods rich in calcium

Calcium is not just for growing kids; adults need it, too, to ensure bone and muscle strength, proper blood clotting, and better nerve impulse regulation. These functions make calcium-rich items great foods after surgery. Since dairy, a common calcium source, increases the risk of constipation, you may want to rely on other options, such as:

- Sardines
- Dar, leafy greens
- Soybeans
- Calcium-fortified products, such as cereals and orange juice

The items above are general suggestions. You still need to follow the doctor's orders when it comes to post-surgery diet and nutrition. For example, whole-wheat bread may be a good fiber source, but if a patient has gluten intolerance, they might want to switch to gluten-free grains. Likewise, some foods that trigger constipation are well-tolerated by others (such as eggs), so the doctor may allow you to have them. The type of surgery and medicines you take also play a role in the kind of post-surgery diet you'll have.

To be absolutely sure on the foods a patient can eat after operation, they need to follow the plan given to them by the physician. After some time, you can get in touch with them again to modify or change their diet.



MODULE SUMMARY

1. After Surgery Care.
2. Infection After Surgery.
3. Signs and Prevention of Infections.
4. Post-Surgery Diet.
5. Foods to Avoid After Surgery.
6. Foods to Eat After Surgery.

